

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Ākāśagarbha, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Āryākāśagarbhanāmāṣṭaśatakadhāraṇīmantrasahita · Toh 876 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ནམ་མཁའ་སྒྲིལ་ལོ་མཚན་བརྒྱ་མར་དྲུག་པ་གཟུངས་སྒྲས་དང་བཅས་པ།

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Ākāśagarbha, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra, known in Tibetan as Phakpa Namkhé Nyingpö Tsen Gya Tsa Gyepa Zung Ngak Dang Chepa, is a short devotional and ritual text in praise of the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha, whose name means "Essence of Space." It opens with homage to Ākāśagarbha as one whose vast countenance and radiant eyes perfume the center of the sky and whose sphere of activity is space itself, illuminating the whole earth. It then presents a brief dhāraṇī. As soon as the dhāraṇī is spoken, the lower realms are pacified, the earth quakes, great drums resound, and all the buddhas voice their approval. After this the Blessed One Vairocana addresses the assembled beings and extols this supreme dhāraṇī of the heart-essence of Ākāśagarbha. The work is Toh 876 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of incantations and name litanies recited for protection, purification, and blessing.

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Ākāśagarbha, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Homage to noble Ākāśagarbha, whose countenance is vast and the light of whose eyes streams forth and makes the center of the sky fragrant.

Homage to the one whose sphere is the sky, who illuminates the whole round of the earth.

oṃ svasti kamālākṣi bipula sambhava dharma dhātu gocara svāhā

As soon as this dhāraṇī had been spoken, all the lower realms and bad destinies were completely pacified. The earth quaked, and the sound of great drums resounded. All the buddhas also gave their "Excellent!"

Then the Blessed One Vairocana declared: "O beings seated in the circle of this assembly, listen to this supreme svāhā dhāraṇī of the directly manifest maṇḍalas of the heart-essence of Ākāśagarbha. It is extremely hard to come upon, of great merit, burning away all wrongdoing and afflictions, the mother of all bodhisattvas, a very heap of jewels. By hearing it you will become stainless, well bathed, and utterly pure. You will become like a lotus, unsullied by the mud of saṃsāra. You will become like the sun, illuminating all sentient

beings. You will become like the moon, thoroughly refreshing all sentient beings. You will become like space, unsullied by any of the sufferings of the lower realms. You will become like the earth, with no high or low. You will become like Mount Meru, which no sentient being can move. You will become like liberation, untouched by pleasure and pain.

"One will obtain these and other qualities, measureless and countless, thousands upon thousands in number. Merely by hearing it, holding it, reading it, reciting it and teaching it, and merely by repeating it, whatever one's wishes, aspirations and hopes may be, they will be fulfilled. Even merely by repeating it, one is fully protected from the sufferings of excessive rain, drought, disturbance by hostility, human epidemics, bad dreams, the arising of harm, times of fear, death, robbers, wilderness, battle, wild beasts and famine; and happiness, wealth, whatever one desires and whatever one delights in will all be accomplished."

Then all those in the assembly cried "Ha ha!" with clamor and laughter, and raising a long cry, they waved their garments and their various ornaments. Bowing from the heart, they recited in full the ocean-like hymn of praise of the one hundred and eight names of noble Ākāśagarbha, who holds mastery over all bodhisattvas:

Ākāśagarbha, supreme being of the three realms of existence,
Rich one, possessed of an ocean of precious intelligence,
Pure being, unsurpassed, supreme jewel,
Seed of liberation, dispeller of the suffering of saṃsāra.

Omniscient one, knower of the ways, knower of good and not good,
Knower of liberation, knower of Dharma, knower of happiness and unhappiness,
Knower of the path, knower of what is precious, knower of virtue and nonvirtue,
Knower of times, knower of the wholesome, knower of strength and what is not strength.

Supreme among beings, supreme in Dharma, a being supreme in qualities,
Supreme path, supreme mantra, supreme in what is fitting and unfitting,
Supreme ornament, supreme Dharma, supreme in grasping and not grasping,
Supreme in purity, supreme in realization, supreme over the supreme and the not supreme.

Best in peace, best in compassion, best of the assembly,
Best in light, best in liberation, best of supports,
Best in vastness, best in mantra, best in loving care,
Best in equality, best of beings, best knower of the three.

Lamp of goodness, supreme lamp, lamp of strength and what is not strength,
Lamp of liberation, lamp of the family, lamp of victory and what is not victory,
Lamp of virtue, lamp of splendor, lamp of the light of jewels,
Lamp arisen from the ornament of the moon and the constellations.

Supreme light, light of the rays of all qualities,
Light of goodness, light of the support, the palace of liberation,
Great light, light that utterly cleaves delusion,
Blazing vajra light, dawning light of bliss.

Lord of the vajra, lord of guides, lord of beings,
Lord adorned with a maṇḍala of jewel light,
Lord of victors, lord of the measureless stream of the Victors' powers,
Hero, lord of the holders of vidyā-mantras, lord of the three realms.

Excellent Vajra, Vajra Light, Blazing Vajra,
Vajrasattva, adorned with blazing vajras,
Radiant Vajra, Vajra Holder, Fierce Vajra,
Vast Vajra, Vajra lord most excellent and supreme.

His robes are blue, and the attire of his body is blue,
His complexion is blue, adorned with blue light,
He holds a sharp and keen sword, blue and steady,
He dwells within a blazing palace of the blue sky.

His divine face is stainless, blazing and utterly unbearable,
Exceedingly fierce, with rays of light streaming and moving,
Dispeller of evil, scattering it like dust, bearer of a supreme garland,
Graceful and steady, shining with the power of lightning.

Wielder of the sword, mighty one, weapon of power,
Wielder of the vajra, terrifying with arrow and short spear,
Wielder of the wheel, whose mount is a mountain and a magical display,
Wielder of the staff, crusher of the power of obstructors.

Source of bliss, lord of the three worlds, vajra staff,
All his forms adorned with the light of the sun,
Born into a renowned family, he reigns as king,

Made graceful and beautiful by garlands of pearls.

He has attained a beautiful form and attained perfection,
Attained the supreme expanse and attained entry into the grounds,
Attained surpassing might and power and attained accomplishment,
Attained the power of the three knowledges and attained might.

Guide to bliss, guide to peace, guide of light,
Guide of bright and supreme attire, guide of great flourishing,
Guide of love, guide like the sun, guide of the people,
Good guide, guide with the power of the field, compassionate one.

Stainless in attire, bright in attire, blazing in attire,
Renowned far and wide, bearer of the banner of fame through his grace,
Opener of the way for beings, knower of engagement and turning back,
He engages with a mind that clearly reveals enjoyments.

Red in form, lofty in form, beautiful in form, excellent in form,
Yellow in form, white in form, form of great flourishing,
Playful in form, possessed of a vajra form, form with lovely eyes,
Form of the family, holder of vidyā-mantras, bearer of a jewel.

Crest jewel, crested one, supreme diadem,
Diademed one, holder of the Dharma, supreme vajra,
Holder of glory, supreme bearer of the sacred jewel,
Perfect holder of the basis of mantra and of mudrā.

Most beautiful, going and moving freely through the sky,
Sole sun of the three realms, possessed of a thousand rays,
Rising on the mountain peak, spreading wide, auspicious,
Renowned for the excellence of his qualities and might.

Great jewel, lovely jewel, light of jewels,
Jewel of the sun, jewel of conduct, blazing jewel,
Wish-fulfilling jewel, sole protector of all beings,
Single jewel shining in the midst of the sky.

Pure being, vast and widely renowned,
Sole guardian of the three realms, supreme son of the victors,
Peaceful, utterly peaceful, ever worthy of refuge,
Prajāpati, lotus-arisen, lotus-born.

Excellent light on every side, possessor of the eloquent Dharma,
Flourishing, eloquent, deeply disciplined, eloquent of hand,
Excellent mind, excellent light, blissful, of excellent birthplace,
Supremely learned, supremely peaceful, endowed with the supreme Dharma.

Pacifier, source of victors, wellspring of bliss,
Source of light, bringer of bliss, who brings all under his power,
Source of goodness, source of wisdom, producer of strength,
Source of compassion, excellent mind, bestower of renown.

Fully liberated, surely liberated, mind utterly liberated,
Vast mind, spread far and wide and widely renowned,
Door to every enjoyment, supreme in mind,
Steadfast intelligence, accomplished through the Three Jewels.

Buddha, with a face like a lotus with petals spread,
Pure, wide-eyed, of pleasing attire,
Essence, clear essence, steadfast and disciplined,
By his very nature attaining continuity, utterly clear.

The arrows of his sidelong glance are perfectly aimed,
Fearless, his face like the autumn moon,
Supreme weapon of a hundred short spears, complete in weapons,
Fierce, terrifying, dispeller of evil, born from the three.

Well disciplined, skilled, delightful company, easy to approach,
Supremely fierce, best of friends, golden in hue,
The Great God (Śiva), Śaṅkara, radiant, bearing it in his hand,
Three-eyed, possessed of the three knowledges, dispeller of the three fires.

Fair Desire, bearing a weapon of flowers, flower arrows,
Clad in fine garments, shooting with the right, shooting mightily,
Beautifully adorned in many ways, with various weapons and various arrows,
Various garments, splendor of various ornaments.

His face is like the moon with its rays in full spread,
By showing his radiant countenance he makes the whole world prosper,
His smile has the exquisite beauty of the sun's rays,
The radiance of his face lights up the ocean, gleaming bright.

Great Lord, a vajra thunderbolt with a terrifying roar,
Fierce vajra, holder of the moving jewel,
Sweet of voice, endowed with the power to illuminate,

Great intelligence, supreme in sharpness of intelligence.

Holder of ornaments, holder of glory, with a precious face,
Abode of all beings, the moving and the unmoving,
Tathāgata, son of the protector, excellent garland,
Of great power, the very essence of the world's intelligence.

Prajāpati, whose commands are impartial and well considered,
Lord of humankind, the cause that brings forth the higher realms,
Like an illusion, master of desire, and vajra-bearer,
Possessed of might, with fine and lovely eyes.

Excellent Teacher, platform of the path of emptiness,
Who leads into the cause by which the three precious things increase,
Steadfast, wholly certain regarding the cause,
Master of all the sacred maṇḍalas.

Sole knower of the maṇḍala rites for beings,
Born from the realm of Vairocana,
Having gained empowerment, abiding well on the ten grounds,
Arrived at the great state, the sole supreme abode.

Whatever supreme son of the sugatas,
Having heard these hundred and eight names,
Which dispel the afflictions of beings and destroy evil,
Recites them, shines in the world like a single rising moon.

Whoever, seated before Ākāśagarbha, the singular being,
Recites this praise at break of day,
Becomes supreme among the beings of the three realms
And is freed from every state of defilement.

When war and terrible strife,
The harm of famine, or human epidemics arise,
Whatever wise person rises early, gives rise to faith,
And offers praise to Ākāśagarbha

Is freed from every source of fear
And from the evils that bring on suffering.
That one will surely attain supreme peace,
The abode of all supreme happiness, and vast bliss.

If one recites it to gain happiness or to increase wealth,
Or to gain kingship, to gain beauty and riches,
To gain noble family, or to accomplish the basis of all good qualities,
It will be accomplished; of this there is no doubt.

Therefore, if one always desires
All the happiness one wishes for,
One should constantly rely on Ākāśagarbha, sole hero for all beings,
Protector of the three realms, and rely on his mantra as well.

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Ākāśagarbha, together with the
Dhāraṇī-Mantra, is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The line rendered "whose mount is a mountain and a magical display" is uncertain; the Tibetan "khrul" could also mean a contrivance or apparatus. The weapon rendered "staff" translates gsal shing, a wooden club or stake whose exact form is unclear here. "Best knower of the three" and "the three knowledges" likely refer to the three knowledges (trividyā).
- Several epithets in this hymn are compressed and admit more than one reading. "Bearing it in his hand" renders a line that names no object. "Born from the three" and "the three precious things" are left as the Tibetan gives them. The stanzas on the Great God, Śaṅkara, and Fair Desire apply epithets of Śiva and Kāma to Ākāśagarbha. "Fair Desire" is a literal rendering, kept for consistency with this text's drafts; the Sanskrit name behind it is not securely identified, though it evidently refers to Kāma. "Great Lord", followed by the vajra thunderbolt, may stand for Mahendra (Indra). In the stanza on hearing the names, the reciter is called "supreme son of the sugatas", that is, a bodhisattva.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.